

Preflight Checklist

12 questions to ask yourself
before a psychedelic journey

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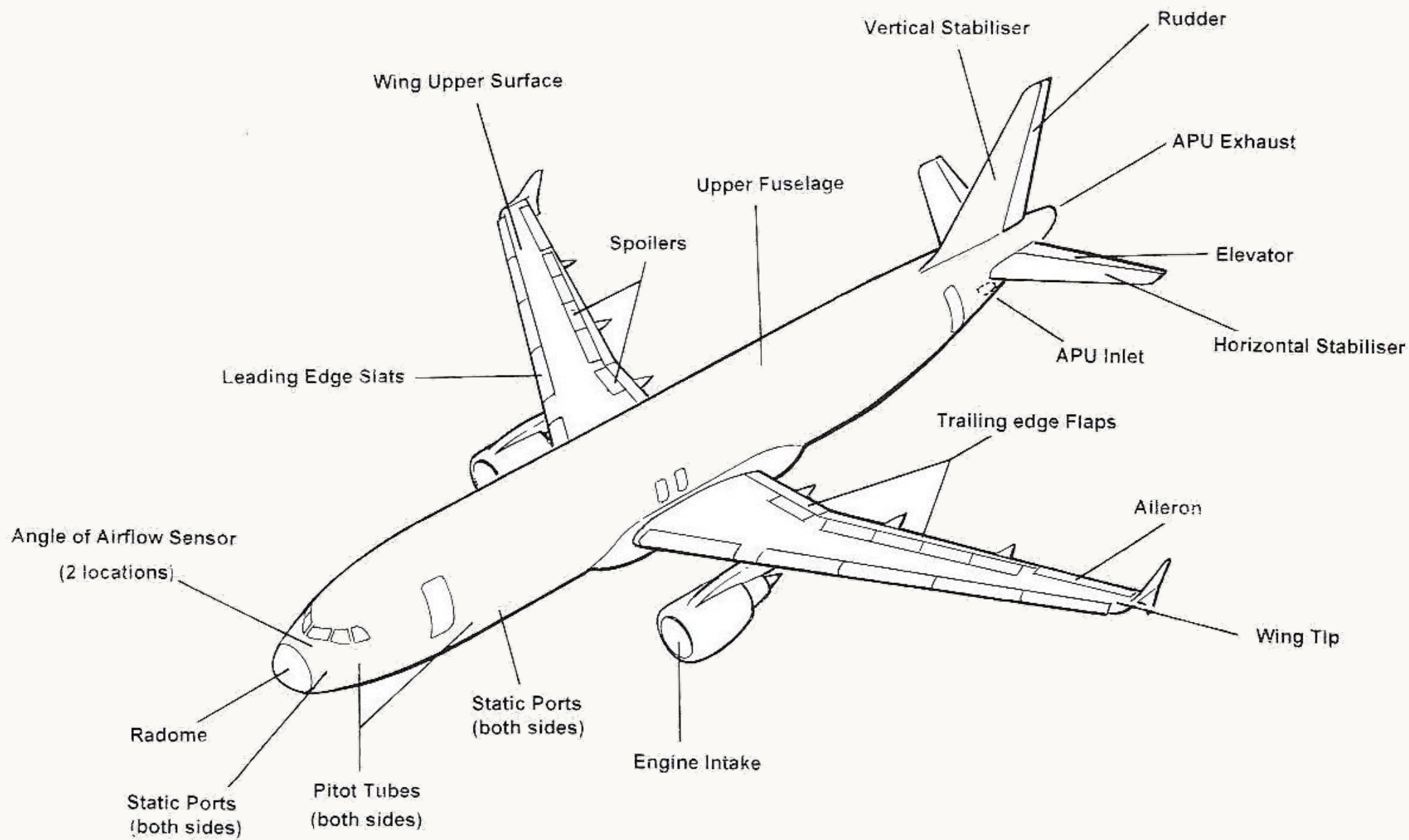
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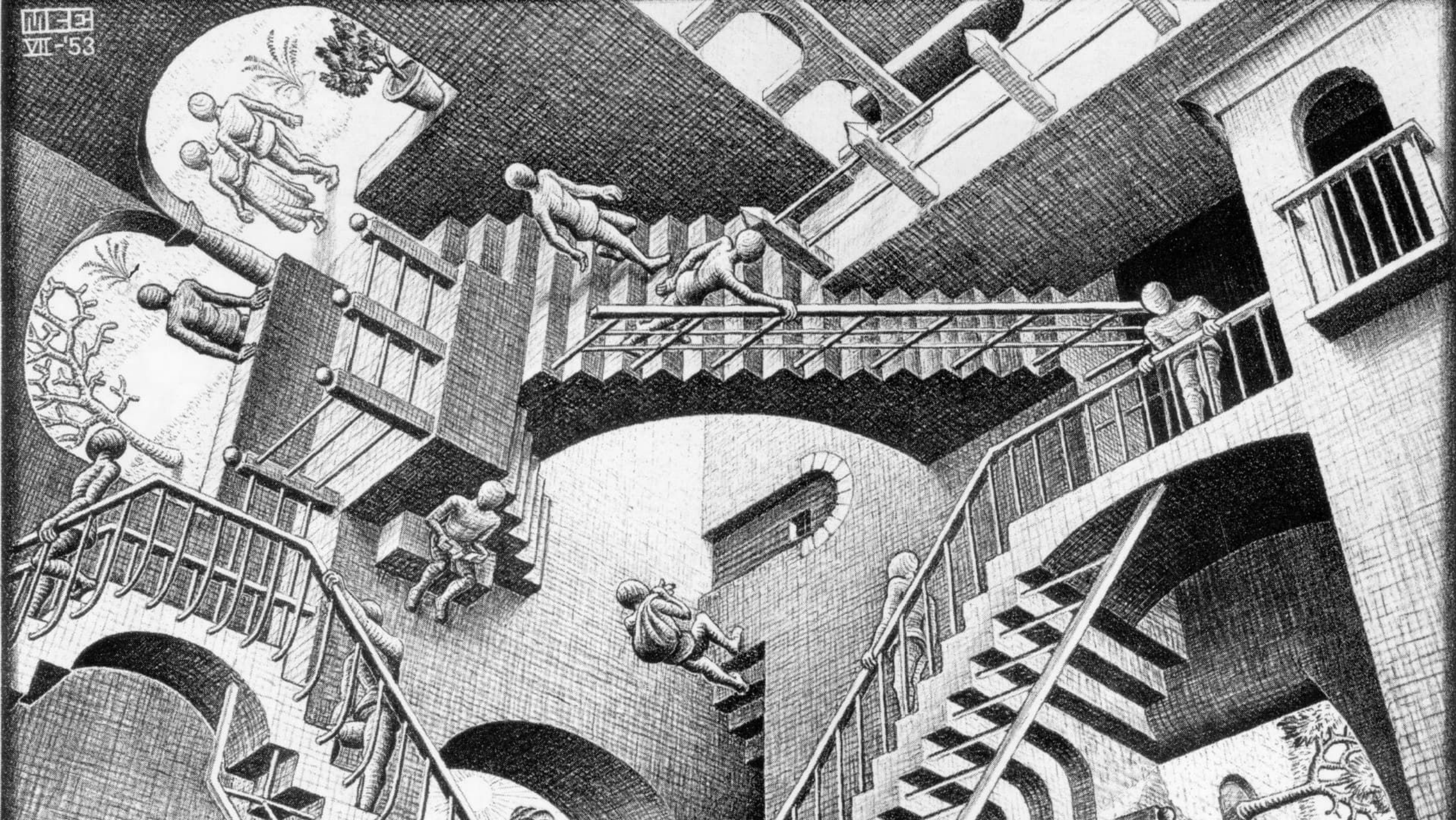
The Fox Cabaret, Vancouver, Canada





If pilots can run a checklist, *so can we.*

Mid-flight *whoopsies* can be *tricky to handle*.



Prepare for more than *a trip.*

What emerges could be both *challenging* & *important*.



Preparation is more than *set & setting.*

It's also *medical* history, safe *supply*, correct *dosage*, a safe *sitter*, intentional *playlist*, and much more.



Prepare for something *existential.*

What emerges could be *life-changing & meaningful.*



Prepare for something *existential*?

What does *existential* even mean?! Do you mean life & death?



How can we prepare *existentially?*

We can *slow down, tune-in & reflect.*

Founders & Knowledge Keepers

Indigenous Knowledge Keepers



María Sabina Magdalena García
Mazotec, Oaxaca, Mexico



Elder Albert Marshall
Etuaptmumk, “Two-Eyed Seeing”

Founders & Knowledge Keepers

Existential Therapy Founders



Martin Buber

Ich und Du
(a.k.a. "I and Thou")



Viktor Frankl

Man's Search for Meaning,
Logotherapy



Alfried Längle

Four Fundamental Motivation,
Existential Analysis

Four Core or Fundamental Existential Questions

FM1 **Can I be?**

Support · Space · Protection

FM2 **Do I like being?**

Time · Closeness · Relating

FM3 **Am I allowed to be me?**

Attention · Appreciation · Justice

FM4 **For what should I live?**

Greater Context · Field of Activity · Future Value



An simple way to prepare *existentially*.

G **Grounded**

Am I stable? Is it safe enough to exist?

R **Relationships**

Am I connected to the vitality of life?

O **Offer**

Do I have permission to be me?

W **Wholeness**

Where do I find meaning in my life?

Can I be?

The ground floor. Whether the world holds you, or whether you are holding yourself up.

Support

What holds when you stop holding yourself up.
A chair, a person, a routine, the floor.

Space

Room to exist without justifying it.
Physical room, and the other kind.

Protection

Somewhere you are not braced.
Not the absence of danger, but a place you can rest.

When it is missing: restlessness, insecurity and fear.

Do I like being?

Not whether life is going well. Whether you are in touch with it, and whether anything still reaches you.

Time

To give something your time is to give away a part of your life.
Worth checking where yours goes.

Closeness

Being near something, and letting it land.
Including plants, animals and places, not only people.

Relating

What you are still in touch with.
What moves you, and what you move towards.

When it is missing: longing, then coldness, and finally depression.

Am I allowed to be me?

Whether you have the right to be who you actually are, in front of other people, without editing or masking.

Attention

Being seen, and looking.

It runs both ways, and the inward direction is the one people skip.

Appreciation

Worth that does not have to be earned again every morning.

Other people's, and your own.

Justice

Being dealt with fairly.

Knowing, without arguing yourself out of it, when you were not.

When it is missing: solitude, and losing hold of who you are.



For what should I live?

What your life is for. Not in the abstract, but the thing that is actually asking to be done.

Greater Context The larger thing you are part of, which gives the rest of it direction.
A family, a field, a faith, a forest.

Field of Activity Somewhere you are needed and can actually do something.
Room to act, not only to be.

Future Value What still wants to happen in your life.
Potential that has not yet been realized.

When it is missing: emptiness, frustration, even despair.



Connect & Reflect

Easy **meditations** & deepening **questions**

One theme each week. **Four** weeks to connect & reflect.



FOUR MEDITATIONS & WORKSHEETS

Four weeks. Tune in, then reflect.

- 1 Tune In**

Listen to the meditation for that Fundamental Motivation.
Nothing to answer yet.
- 2 Sit or Lay**

When the meditation is over, give yourself two or three minutes afterwards with nothing to do.
- 3 Reflect**

Look at the three questions, one per existential need.
Best to write by hand if you can, if not try audio notes.
- 4 Leave Space**

Come back to the page later in the week and add what surfaced.
Add any other reflections that have emerged.

FOUR MEDITATIONS

The meditation sequence

FM ₁	“Can I be... here... now?”	15-20 min
FM ₂	“Do I like being... here... now?”	30-35 min
FM ₃	“Am I allowed to be myself... here... now?”	35-40 min
FM ₄	“Is this... a purposeful... life?”	40-45 min

Try it out!

Both are free for personal use.



The Meditations & Worksheets

<https://research.aestra.ca/ea-preflight>

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Bibliography & Credits

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